



NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

ADMINISTRATION OFFICE | LEVEL 1 | CITY
HALL ANNEX BUILDING | WAIGANI, NATIONAL
CAPITAL DISTRICT.
P O BOX 1392, PORT MORESBY,
NATIONAL CAPITAL DISTRICT

TO : The Board
(Chairman Ryan Pini and the Board Members)

DATE : 8th August 2022

SUBJECT : **Brief Report on Q1 & Q2 2022 Progress**

A. PURPOSE

Pursuant to section 7 (e), (f) and (g) of the Small Craft Act 2011, I hereby submit our Q1 and Q2 consolidated report for 2022. The purpose of this brief is to provide summary report on the performance so far from the management and administrative aspects since its establishment. I will also highlight few areas of concern and recommendations which will requires the boards consideration and approval.

1. WHAT WE ACHIEVED SO FAR

1.1 Inspectors Training

- a) We managed to put together 21 Inspector's in August last year (2021) as part of the first phase of setting up NCD Small Craft Registration Board. All Inspectors underwent a 3-day Training workshop at Gateway Hotel facilitated by NMSA in last November and were certified after the training.
- b) It was a hurdle resourcefully and financially putting together Inspectors and organizing transport and logistics support arrangements especially during the Training period at Gateway Hotel in November last.
- c) A big thank you to our Board Chairman (Ryan) for stepping in to assist financially. Without his assistance I wouldn't have been able to get the job done. While I am still on this "Inspectors" subject, I must inform you all



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that, half of our Inspectors have left us for other offers or job opportunities elsewhere.

- d) It is however, at a reasonable number to commence operation's considering the limited funding issue and proper determination processes.

1.2 Ela Motors Sponsorship/Donation

- a) The vehicle donated is a used Toyota Hilux within the Ela Motors Security Fleet. It had already clocked close to an estimated 265,000km mileage upon receipt. Considerably a good vehicle to have and I acknowledged the sponsorship or donation from Ela Motors. And thank you chairman Ryan for establishing the negotiations and partnership.

1.3 Bank Account

- a) It took us almost 7 months to have the account opened. Unfortunately, it had to go through Department of Finance approval process and system within Cash Management Division then through to the Secretary's Office for final approval and confirmations letter from the Secretary. You can imagine the trail and red tapes it had to endure.
- b) We finally, got it opened in June and we now have our own bank account with Bank South Pacific Paramount Branch with access to ***Online Internet Banking and Premium Banking Services.***



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2. WORK-IN-PROGRESS

2.1 Funding

- a) Funding remains our biggest hurdle which stagnates our whole operation until we receive our full allocated funding of K200,000.00 from NCD only then we can fully operate the registry. However, NCD have allocated 100k this month hence the need for the board to convene a special or first meeting of the year to approve on an operational budget to commence operations. However, we are yet to submit our proposals to Moresby North West and Moresby South Office.
- b) There are dialogues already established by Ryan with the incumbent members of both electorates so once they are settled in their office, we will make appointments in the coming weeks to submit our submissions. Both proposals are ready for perusal and approval by Chairman for submission.

2.3 SCAIP

- a) The Small Craft Act Implementation Programs (SCAIP) phase one Awareness/Education Program requires proper planning, coordination and engagement. AWARENESS/EDUCATION program Plan with a Scope of Work has been prepared and will be reported separately for perusal and endorsement.
- b) Phase two Inspection and Registration Program requires proper planning, coordination and engagement. Inspection/Registration program Plan with a Scope of Work has been prepared and will be reported separately for perusal and endorsement.



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2.4 Registration App

- a) A Registration Application has been developed by Richard MacArthur from RMC PNG Ltd and is ready to be launched. However, the developers require a part payment for them to release a demo version for trial basis.
- b) If we make full purchase, we can fully own its user licenses and then use it to loan it out to other interested maritime provinces or parties at a reasonable monthly subscription rate.
- c) The App can be interfaced with NMSA and Ela Motors systems for Safety, Monitoring and Evaluation purposes.
- d) It will also generate additional income for us with monthly subscriptions mentioned above.

2.5 Staff Structure

- a) The recruiting structure needs to be arranged properly in terms of determination and facilitation of staff (Inspectors/Admin staff's) terms and conditions or remunerations.
- b) The Small Craft Act does not mention for Registrar and Inspectors or admin staffs other than the board members in section 4 (3) of the small craft act.
- c) We have options either we accommodate them in our Operational budget or squeeze them in the NCDC casual employment system. I have elaborated further on the issue below under facts and consideration.



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3. CORRESPONDENCES RESPONDED AND PENDING RESPONSE/APPROVAL

3.1 Office Space

- a) In December last year, Mr. Augustine Ravi who is the Financial Advisor to the NCDC, verbally allocated the office space currently vacated by NCDPHA at level 1 City Hall Annex building. The office is suitable for our small set up.
- b) For formality purposes, I have written to Mr. Ravu Frank our City Manager and board member for approval. We are yet to know the status; however, I understand he has a lot on his plate now and would appreciate if a response could be made before end of this month.
- c) My job requires proper planning, coordination and implementation; hence I am begging this board to arrange a proper set up so I can function as a Small Craft Registry Office with 2 to 3 support staffs.

3.2 Steamships Trading Company

- a) We have written to Mr. Rupert Bray the Managing Director of Steamships early this year in February. He has responded well hence; a dialogue is established now between us and their General Manager Corporate Services Mr. Rupa Vele whom we've met couple of weeks ago to discuss possible sponsorship or donation ideas.
- b) The meeting with Steamships was very fruitful and they are very keen to assist us but might not be on monetary terms. The positive take back is our presence and to create partnerships within the private or corporate sector.



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B. FACTS/CONSIDERATION

1. Salary Determinations for Small Craft Staff

As you're aware the *Small Craft Act* does not state with certainty from which source shall funding for the wages or of the staffs of the NCD SCRB shall be sought from. Section 4(3) only provides for the terms and conditions of members of Registration Boards are to be determined by the relevant Provincial Executive Council (in this case, NCDC), however, there are no such similar provisions for the small craft inspectors nor other staffs employed by the NCD SCRB.

Thus, in reading the *Small Craft Act* as a whole it is clear that the NCD SCRB will be subjected to NCDC as Section 3(1) gives mandate to NCDC to establish a small craft board for NCD and in that regard I submit that NCDC make provisions to cater for salary determinations of the staffs of NCD SCRB.

2. NAMING CONVENTION (NCDMK Small Craft Registration Board)

Secondly, it is a legal registry board set up by the municipal government of National Capital District (NCD) pursuant to the *Small Craft Act* 2011 (SCA) for purposes of administering and regulating the functions under the *Small Craft Act* 2011. NCD is a maritime province, and by law it is imperative that the naming be aligned with its provincial abbreviations. For uniformity sake, the name to change to rather NCD Small Craft Registration Board.



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C. RECOMMENDATION

Current or main pressing issues from my end operationally and administratively is **proper set up, Staffing and Salary determination or remuneration facilitations**. *Small Craft Act* concerns and is declared to be a matter of national interest and dealing with a matter of national importance. Any functions perform pursuant to the Act therefore binds the State pursuant to Section 1(4). Just like any Government institution or organization, the NCD SCRB is a creature of an Act of Parliament and is a Government authority by law. As such, I strongly recommend the board to deliberate further and consider alternate solutions or provisions for the long-term and short-term development goals of the Small Craft Registration Board.

Yours Sincerely

Hitolo Garia

Registrar